

SANDEEP BAZAR

Senior Engineering Manager | Platform Engineering, Kubernetes & Applied AI

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SUMMARY

Engineering manager with 14 years at IBM India Systems and Development Lab, now running several squads on hybrid-cloud platform infrastructure: virtualization, hosted control planes, multicluster management and observability. Builds teams from the first hire through to production adoption, stays close to the architecture, and spent four years owning round-the-clock escalations for global enterprise deployments. Six granted US patents. Executive PhD in progress at IIM Udaipur. Also owns agentic AI for the platform: where an agent helps, how it reaches production safely, and the tooling behind it.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built the Virtualization and Multicluster squads from the first hire through to production adoption.
- Founding member of IBM's Modern Data Protection team in Pune. It began with around 20 engineers and is past 50 today.
- Six granted US patents, two IBM Redbooks, an IEEE paper and an OpenStack Summit talk.
- Own agentic AI for the platform: where agents help, how they reach production systems safely, and the tooling behind it.

CORE SKILLS

Leadership	Building and scaling teams Hiring and career development Technical vision and roadmap Distributed, matrixed organizations
Platforms	Kubernetes and OpenShift KubeVirt and hosted control planes Open Cluster Management Docker
Storage & data	IBM Fusion IBM Storage Scale OpenStack Swift NFS, SMB, object Backup and recovery
Applied AI	Agentic system design Agent guardrails, approval and audit AI-assisted diagnostics and operations LLM application and evaluation patterns MCP, watsonx.ai
Engineering	Go, Python, C/C++, Java, Linux Prometheus, Loki, Elasticsearch Jenkins, Git, Docker

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Development Manager - IBM Storage Fusion

Sep 2022 - Present

IBM India Systems and Development Lab

Pune, India

Promoted from Senior Technical Lead.

- Lead engineering across virtualization, hosted control planes, multicluster management and observability in IBM Fusion.
- Own agentic AI for the platform. Decide where an agent helps, design how it reaches production systems safely, and build the tooling in Go.
- Built the Virtualization and Multicluster squads from scratch, from hiring and technical direction through to the first production deployments.
- Own priorities, roadmap and production readiness for enterprise hybrid-cloud infrastructure.
- Run goal-setting, reviews and development plans across several squads.
- Led the architecture of the observability framework and built it in Go on Prometheus, Loki and Elasticsearch. Improved several existing platform microservices.
- Lab advocate for large enterprise accounts, so field problems reach engineering as prioritized work.
- Drive AI-assisted diagnostics and platform-operations work to improve serviceability.

Technical Lead - Storage Scale, Data Protection & Escalation Engineering

Feb 2016 - Aug 2022

IBM India Systems and Development Lab

Pune, India

- Founding member of IBM's Modern Data Protection team in Pune. Set up hiring, onboarding and the lab; it started with around 20 engineers and is past 50 today.
- Led IBM Storage Scale Object on OpenStack Swift across RHEL and Ubuntu, owning design, review and the Jenkins build and release pipeline.
- Four years as the Asia-Pacific escalation engineer for Spectrum Scale on a 24/7 rota, working CritSits directly with global customers.
- Wrote diagnostic tooling that cut the time it took to isolate distributed-storage failures.
- Co-authored two IBM Redbooks. Mentored engineers into test, build and lead roles.

Software Engineer - Storage, Security & Cloud Platforms

Oct 2012 - Jan 2016

IBM India Systems and Development Lab

Pune, India

- Owned quality engineering and automation for SONAS, V7000 Unified and Spectrum Scale.
- Led authentication and security certification across Active Directory, LDAP, NIS and OpenStack Keystone, and qualified the NFS, SMB, object and SNIA CDMI stacks.
- Ran continuous integration and fix propagation across several concurrent release streams.
- Wrote Java and Python tools for object storage and storage-utilization reporting.

Software Engineering Intern

Sep 2011 - Sep 2012

IBM India Systems and Development Lab

Pune, India

- Built a cloud storage and sync service for SONAS and V7000 Unified in Java on SNIA CDMI. It won the IBM Innovation Showcase and became an IEEE paper.
- Wrote a log-analysis tool in PHP and MySQL that support engineers used to cut down debugging time.

EDUCATION

Executive PhD, Operations Management (in progress)

Jul 2025 - Jun 2028

Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Udaipur

Research area: artificial intelligence and technology management.

M.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering

2010 - 2012

KIIT University, Bhubaneswar

CGPA 9.39. AICTE GATE Scholarship, two years.

B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering

2006 - 2010

Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University

PATENTS - SIX GRANTED, UNITED STATES

- Dynamic control of a smart home using a wearable device - US 10072866, US 10250403, US 9473321
- Controlling implantable medical devices using wearable technology - US 10226632
- Identifying and managing redundant digital content transfers - US 10419557
- Overriding feature to unblock contacts in energy-saving mode - US 9965024

PUBLICATIONS, TALKS & OPEN SOURCE

- IBM Redbook - IBM Spectrum Scale Security (REDP-5426), 2018
- IBM Redbook - Deployment Guide for IBM Spectrum Scale Unified File and Object Storage (REDP-5113), 2017
- IEEE - Enterprise Compatible Cloud Object Storage and Synchronization Service, 2012
- OpenStack Summit, Tokyo - Mobilize Platform Agnostic Adaptability for Object Store, 2015
- IBM Community - Bringing Agentic AI to IBM Fusion Fleet, 2026
- Medium - article series on IBM Fusion, Kubernetes MCP and agentic operations, 2026
- IBM Storage Strategy Days and IBM user-group sessions - customer-facing technical presentations
- ibm-fusion-mcp-server - maintainer. Fork of the open-source Kubernetes MCP server (Go), extended with IBM Fusion tools.
- ocm-mcp-server - author. Puts policy checks, approval and audit between an AI agent and a Kubernetes fleet, so the agent never holds credentials.
- ai-roadmap-365 - author. Open-source nine-course AI curriculum, from computing fundamentals to designing, evaluating, securing and deploying production AI systems. 141 of 365 lessons published.

AWARDS & CERTIFICATIONS

- Winner, IBM Innovation Showcase (2012), for a cloud object storage and sync prototype on SNIA CDMI
 - IBM Execution Excellence and Eminence (2017); IBM Collaborative Influence (2017)
 - IBM Team Excellence (2018); IBM New IBMer (2013); Star of the Month, several times
- CompTIA Storage+ (SNIA) | IBM watsonx.ai Technical Essentials | IBM License to Lead, First-Line Manager | IBM Agile Explorer

Endurance and ultra runner, including 300+ km single-stage events.